

6 28010 000333

TUESDAY
JUNE 23, 2026
MUHARRAM 8, 1448

TRUSTED NEWS SINCE 1978

gulfnews.com
GULF NEWS



LIVE
UPDATES



Cargo, Courier,
Shipping, logistics

800 916
www.abccargo.com

3154865 141



SALAH SOARS AS EGYPT DELIVER FIRST WORLD CUP WIN IN 92 YEARS

■ Mohamed Salah (10) of Egypt celebrates scoring his team's second goal during the World Cup match against New Zealand at BC Place Vancouver, British Columbia, on Sunday. The 3-1 victory secured the nation's first win at football's biggest tournament after 92 years of waiting and moved them to the top of Group G. Egypt are making their fourth World Cup appearance after missing out in Qatar four years ago. Salah scored a pair of goals in the 2018 World Cup in Russia.

SEE ALSO P12-13

Emirates offers free Dubai hotel stays

DUBAI
BY DHANUSHA
GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

Emirates flyers travelling to or through Dubai this summer can get a complimentary stay at the five-star JW Marriott Marquis, along with access to hundreds of city discounts through My Emirates Pass.

The airline has launched a summer offer that allows travellers to turn a Dubai stopover into a short city break or extend their holiday, with free hotel stays available for eligible return ticket bookings or with a Dubai stopover of more than 24 hours, for travel between June 25 and September 30.

Flyers booking return tickets in First Class or Business Class between June 22 and July 12 can receive a two-night stay at JW Marriott Marquis, while those travelling in Premium Economy or Economy Class can receive a complimentary one-night stay.

Vance: US-Iran talks lay foundation for final deal

Progress reported on Hormuz, Lebanon and sanctions

OBBERG, SWITZERLAND

US Vice-President JD Vance said yesterday that marathon talks with Iranian officials in Switzerland had created a "good foundation" for a permanent agreement to end the war, as negotiators moved into a critical technical phase. "The final deal is the house. We set the foundation," Vance told reporters after talks with Iranian parliamentary speaker Mohammad Bagher Qalibaf. "We haven't built the house, but we've laid a successful foundation to get to a good place."

The talks, which began Sunday and stretched into the early hours of yesterday, produced what mediators Qatar and Pakistan described as "encouraging progress", despite tensions triggered by public exchanges between US President Donald Trump and Iranian leaders.

A key outcome was the establishment of mechanisms aimed at keeping the Strait of Hormuz open and maintaining a ceasefire in Lebanon, where fighting between Israel and Iran-backed Hezbollah has threatened to derail diplomacy.

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi also reported "major progress" on efforts to end the Lebanon conflict, calling it the first real test of the negotiations.

60-day framework

The talks are being held under a 60-day framework agreed by Washington and Tehran following last week's interim accord. Technical teams will remain in Switzerland this week to work on issues including Iran's nuclear programme, sanctions relief and dispute-resolution mechanisms. In a significant step, the US Treasury issued a 60-day licence waiving sanctions on Iranian oil exports through August 21. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said the move reflected "ongoing productive talks in Switzerland".

Vance also floated the possibility of unfreezing some Iranian assets to allow purchases of American agricultural products such as soybeans, corn and wheat under Qatari oversight.

The diplomatic progress appeared to calm markets, with oil prices edging lower on hopes that a broader agreement could ease tensions and stabilise energy supplies across the region.

— AP

SEE ALSO P6

Starmer resigns as UK PM, Burnham set to take over

Policy U-turns, public unpopularity, and ministerial resignations marked his tenure

LONDON

UK leader Keir Starmer announced his resignation yesterday following months of pressure, kickstarting a process that will see Britain get its seventh prime minister in a decade.

Veteran politician Andy Burnham, who secured a return to parliament just last week, appeared poised to succeed Starmer after would-be rival Wes Streeting offered him his support.

Starmer's voice cracked during an emotional speech outside 10 Downing Street, as he conceded he had lost the support of his Labour party MPs after just two years in office.

King Charles III informed

He said he had informed head of state King Charles III of his decision to resign so that a new Labour leader, and therefore prime minister, could be elected.

"I will remain in post as prime minister until the contest is complete, and I will do everything I can to ensure an orderly



AFP

■ Keir Starmer

handover of power," Starmer said, choking back tears when he thanked his wife Victoria and two children.

Starmer returned Labour to power after 14 years in opposition with a landslide general election victory over the Conservatives in July 2024.

But his premiership quickly became characterised by policy U-turns, deep public unpopularity, and ministerial resignations.

Labour lawmakers have ultimately decided he is incapable of fighting off the rise of the hard-right anti-immigration Reform UK party, which leads national opinion polls.

Starmer's domestic authority has been waning since Labour

endured a drubbing in local and regional elections, including to Reform, in May, with clamour growing for Burnham to replace him. Starmer had vowed to fight any leadership challenge but several senior ministers reportedly told him the game was up after Burnham won a parliamentary by-election last week, allowing him to run for leader.

Minister under Blair, Brown

Burnham, a former Labour minister under Tony Blair and Gordon Brown who has been mayor of Greater Manchester since 2017, was sworn in as a member of parliament yesterday.

"The question my party is asking now is whether I am best placed to lead us into the next general election," Starmer said, as senior ministerial colleagues looked on. "I have heard the answer of my parliamentary party to that question, and I accept that answer with good grace."

"Every decision I have taken has been about putting the country I love first. That is why I will resign as leader of the Labour Party," he added. Starmer said he had asked Labour's National Executive Committee to set out a timetable for his replacement, with nominations due to open on July 9.

— AFP

SEE ALSO P10, 11